

Grown-up's Playbook: The Lost Little Aurora

The answers are here. This part is for the grown-up, not for the child.

The Lost Little Aurora: Rules for the Grown-Up

New to this? Read the Guide for the Grown-Up first. It explains the whole idea in two pages and you will never need it again.

You are the Game Master, which here means a few small jobs at once: storyteller, gentle referee, the children's biggest fan, and a fellow adventurer who plays along. This is a cooperative game for two or more who play together, a grown-up and one or more children, all on the same side. Nobody competes, and nobody loses. This is a gentle tale, soft and warm, where cleverness and kindness win every time and no one is ever truly hurt.

Setting up

- Print the map. Each player puts a small figure on the Start, the Hearth Hall.
- This world has no magic. Instead each hero leans on one of three qualities: **Wit** (clever thinking), **Courage** (a steady heart), or **Heart** (caring for others). On the hero sheet, where it says magic, let each child write the quality they like best. Two different qualities work best together.
- Give each player five energy stars (five small tokens or bricks). They are spent and refilled during play.
- Set out three props if you can: a small light or token for the little lantern, a ball of red string for the red yarn, and any small thing at all for the honey bun. Anything can be anything.
- Keep your dice and the dice-band table from the back of the kit beside you.

Difficulty bands, not dice

Challenges never call for a particular die. Each one has a band: **Easy**, **Normal**, or **Hard**. When the players try something, look up the band on the kit's dice-band table, which tells you the number to meet or beat with whatever dice your family owns. Every challenge can be played with a single ordinary die.

The golden rule: here nobody loses

A failed roll is never a defeat. It is a detour to a different route. When a roll does not meet the band, the players always have a way through:

- **Spend an energy star** to gather themselves and try the idea again, or
- **Join two qualities** once per stop to pass with no roll at all (Wit and Heart together, say, or Courage and Wit).

Energy stars come back when the players move on to the next stop, and when they help each other. Nobody can ever run dry for long, and nobody is ever stuck.

Helping each other: the Helping Hand

At any moment one player may help another instead of acting alone. When they do, make the help roll: on a success the challenge is passed for the pair, even if the first roll missed.

Helping is generous, so reward it; it also tops up an energy star. In these fjords, no hero stands alone.

The Twist of Fate

At each stop, once, the players may roll for a twist and you read out the matching line. Use whichever die the dice-band table gives you for this; with a single ordinary die, read the line that matches the number rolled.

Roll	Twist of Fate
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1	Nori the Tomte pops up and gives you one free hint.
2	You find your courage again, and take back one energy star.
3	A friendly wind off the fjord, and the next challenge is Easy.
4	The Two Ravens fly over and nod kindly. All is well.
5	A lucky strand of red yarn: keep one roll to use again later.
6	A burst of warmth from the hearth, and for a moment everyone feels brave.

How it ends

The little aurora is too shy and too cold to glow, but she is no villain and there is no foe in this tale at all. It is won not by beating anyone but by finding her, helping her gather her three colours, and lending her the courage to leap back into the sky. Let the kindness land; it is the whole point. See the puzzles page for the three challenges and their solutions.

The Lost Little Aurora: Puzzles and Solutions

For your eyes, not the children's. Each stop lists its band, what the players need to work out, the intended solution, and a gentle fallback so a stuck child always moves forward. More than one good idea should work; reward cleverness and kindness over the "right" answer.

Stop 1: The Dark Forest (Easy)

The challenge. The littlest Aurora Spirit is hiding among the snowy pines, shy and cold and very small. The players must find her without frightening her away.

Intended solution. This is a moment for Observation and Heart. The clever, kind move is to slow down and look gently: watch for the faint glimmer of her light, follow small footprints in the snow, and speak softly so she is not scared. Asking **Nori the Tomte**, the red-capped hearth sprite, for a hint works just as well.

Fallback. If the children cannot spot her, have her own light flicker for a moment behind a particular tree, or let Nori peek out and point with a wink. The gentlest look or the kindest word brings her out; any honest attempt to find her counts as a full success and tops up an energy star.

Stop 2: The Three Colours (Normal)

The challenge. The little aurora has lost her three colours, teal, green and purple, and cannot glow until the players help her gather them back. Each colour is hiding in something in the world that wears it.

Intended solution. This is an Observation and Logic moment. The clever idea is to match each colour to the world around them: **teal** from a shining icicle, **green** from a dark pine branch, and **purple** from the deepening twilight sky. Naming any sensible source of each colour works; the point is matching colour to thing, not one single correct object.

Fallback. If they are stuck on a colour, let the little aurora glance hopefully toward the right place ("an icicle catches her eye"), or have Nori hum and tip his head at it. Each colour found makes her glow a little brighter, and finding them with help still counts in full.

Stop 3: The Climb to the Sky (Normal)

The challenge. The little aurora glows again, but she is afraid to rise. She fears the sky is too high and that she will only fall once more. The players must help her find the courage to climb a tall pine and leap back up.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Courage moment. Any warm encouragement works: climbing the tallest pine alongside her, cheering her on, counting her up to the leap, or using the **red yarn** to give her a gentle boost up into the air. When the children lend her their courage, she takes a breath and leaps.

Fallback. If she hesitates, or the children are unsure how to help, have her ask quietly, "Will you count with me?" A single kind, brave word is enough. The moment the players cheer her on in any way at all, she gathers herself and rises.

The ending

There is no battle and no loser. When the little aurora leaps back into the sky, the other **Aurora Spirits** swoop down to welcome her home, and the whole night sky dances with teal, green and purple over the snowy fjord. High among the stars, **Freya the Kind** smiles down. The heroes have won the only way anyone wins here, by being clever, brave, and kind.

Wits and Wonder

Grown-up's Playbook

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.